

Data Retention & Deletion

Purpose

Define what data is retained, why it is retained, and how it can be deleted.

Data retained

- Authentication data:
 - Email address
 - Password hash (bcrypt)
- Plaid linkage:
 - Plaid item identifier
 - Plaid access token (server-side secret; not shared with clients)
- Financial data used for the application:
 - Account identifiers/metadata
 - Transaction records (amount/date/merchant/category fields)

Retention period

- Data is retained while the account is active to support the dashboard and transaction history.

Deletion

- When the user requests deletion (or the account is no longer used), the following are deleted from the database:
 - Plaid item record
 - Accounts and transactions
 - User record
- Deletion is performed by direct database deletion (cascading deletes are configured in the schema).

Logs

- The application avoids logging sensitive credentials (passwords, Plaid tokens).
- Operational logs (if enabled by hosting provider) are retained per provider defaults and are reviewed for sensitive content.

Backups

- Database backups (if enabled) are managed by the database provider.
- If backups exist, deleted data may persist until backup rotation completes.